

Matter Ops — Product Brief

Private paralegal agents for high-volume matters

Draft for Graham · 2026-08-14 · Internal product brief — not a legal services offering

One-liner. *Private matter ops: sort the dump, build the docket, prepare the packet, run the checklist — **cite the file or stop**; a lawyer approves anything that leaves the building. Not legal advice. Not a full firm OS. A **local work-product factory** that eats days of paralegal and associate grind.*

1. Buyer & job-to-be-done

Primary buyer	Small–mid firm partner or managing paralegal drowning in discovery / productions
User	Paralegal + attorney (human gate on outbound)
Job	“We got 15,000 pages and hard dates — make it legible, scheduled, and ready to act without inventing facts.”
Why local	Client confidentiality; firm keeps corpus and work product on hardware they control

2. What it is / is not

Is	Is not
Document intake, sort, summarize with page cites	Legal advice or strategy counsel
Deterministic docket / deadline engine	“AI guessed a statute of limitations”
Drafts from firm templates + matter facts only	Replacement for the lawyer’s judgment
Packets, checklists, filing prep	Unsupervised e-file as the product identity
Multi-agent house (Soveryn-shaped)	Chatbot bolted onto a cloud drive

3. Agent cast

Agent	Angle	Output
Clerk	Structure	Inventory, classification, duplicates, hot-doc shortlist (cited)
Chronicler	Narrative	Timeline, parties, issue map (every claim → doc + page)
Auditor	Stress	Gaps, contradictions, missing exhibits (cited or “not in the record”)
Docket	Calendar	Deadlines from rules + trigger events (computed, not freelanced)
Drafter	Execute	First-pass drafts from firm templates + verified facts
Runner	File / serve prep	Checklist → assemble packet → human approve → export / gated connector

4. End-to-end flow

Open matter → Ingest corpus (to ~15k pages) → **Clerk / Chronicler / Auditor** (parallel) → **Docket** builds calendar (rules + orders + filed dates) → Work queue (draft / obtain / file / serve / wait) → **Drafter** prepares packet → Attorney/paralegal **APPROVES** → **Runner** exports or submits via gated connector → Receipt vaulted; calendar advances; audit log forever.

Shared law with Shepherd & History’s Ledger: ground in real data; refuse to invent; print gaps.

5. V1 scope (ship this first)

- Matter + document room (immutable originals + page map)
- Three-angle analysis — Clerk, Chronicler, Auditor
- Docket engine — jurisdiction/practice narrow at first; dates computed from rules + triggers
- Work queue + packet assembly + approve-to-export
- Audit log — who ran what on which corpus

V1 non-goals: full PMS (billing, trust, conflicts), multi-jurisdiction e-file, Westlaw replacement, unsupervised court filing, “answer any legal question.”

V2: firm calendar sync; email of approved packets; one e-file path (one court). **V3:** more filing adapters; service workflows; optional time capture.

6. Docket & document principles

Docket (Shepherd DNA). Engine computes deadlines from structured rules + events. Model may explain which rule applied. Model must not freestyle “you probably have 30 days.” Missed-date integrity is the product test — same as Shepherd FCC fines.

Documents (Ledger DNA). Every summary claim → document id + page (range) or “not in the record.” Privilege flags are candidates only. Nothing client- or court-facing leaves without approve.

7. Pricing (directional)

Price against days of paralegal/associate time and deadline risk — not chat seats. Per-matter for high-volume productions; firm seat/month for ongoing multi-matter desk; private deploy premium for confidentiality. Exact numbers after pilot.

8. Relationship to existing work

Product	Role
Soveryn	Runtime DNA: multi-agent house, desks, duties, local control
Shepherd FCC	Pattern: deterministic compliance / deadlines; Graham + radio path
History’s Ledger / Atticus	Pattern: cite-or-stop; print gaps
Matter Ops (this)	Vertical: firm matter intake → docket → packet → gated execution

Do not sell “Soveryn for lawyers” as the brand. Sell Matter Ops (name TBD) with the same honesty rules.

9. Partnership sketch (Jon / Graham)

	Focus
Domain / wedge	Graham: buyer path & vertical story (radio Shepherd now; legal ops if intros exist)
Platform / integrity	Jon: agents, local stack, cite-or-stop, docket engine discipline
Must agree first	IP, customer ownership, support, liability framing (“not legal advice”)

10. Pilot success criteria

- One real matter corpus (thousands+ pages)
- Attorney finds inventory + timeline + docket usable without redoing from scratch
- Zero known invented cites in pilot review
- At least one full packet assemble → human approve → export loop
- Filing connector optional; prep quality is the pilot bar

11. Ask / next step

Align on: (1) first practice + jurisdiction for docket rules, (2) pilot firm or synthetic corpus, (3) v1 only as above — then build the matter desk + three agents + docket spine.